

MOVIE

Space Sweepers

★★★★☆ | Space Sweepers is an epic action adventure set in space. Set in the year 2092, it has mankind expanding across the solar system, with a history of disasters in space. The lagrangian points have accumulated dust clouds of space debris, broken down by nearly indestructible nanobot swarms. There are other derelicts and junk strewn out all across the solar system, and trying to make a quick buck by scavenging through all the waste dumped into space are our heroes, the Space Sweepers clearing the Earth orbit of debris. This is a crew in a spaceship and they have fun adventures. This ensemble is made up of a reckless robot with a prosthetic limb who



likes using harpoons, a space pirate captain and idealistic assassin, an expert mechanic who can fix up anything, a former child soldier making amends and a kid lost in space. They are up against the hero of everyone across the solar system, the CEO of

a megacorporation who managed to terraform Mars. The thing is all of them are hiding a dark secret and dealing with their own issues, and this is another story of how people can use the networks formed in families and communities to overcome obstacles. Underneath all the technological advancement is a conspiracy of course, one that the crew uncovers while trying to save the kid from a series of dangers.

This is an easy to consume dose of cyberpunk, is scientifically accurate and allows us to see a number of really cool futuristic concepts (think space elevators on Mars). The action sequences in space are a treat and this movie is worth watching just to watch Bubs wield their harpoon like an expert in zero gravity. Despite all of this it is not the top notch CGI, or the well planned out space battles that make the movie so compelling, but the characters who are all relatable, and are dealing with familiar everyday issues, including the villain.

ANIME

Toradora

★★★★☆ | Toradora can be considered a classic anime at this point, since it aired more than 10 years ago, all the way back in 2008 (yes, that statement makes us feel old). This is an exceptional romcom (romantic comedy), slice of life anime that we would recommend to both fans of the genre (if they haven't watched it already), and those who are looking to branch out and try something new.

While Toradora does display some of the tropes one associates with romcom anime, there's something about the execution that just takes the cake. The key thing that makes it all work is the characters. Toradora has an exceptional cast of characters, each with plenty of depth to them and they all have some motivation or reasoning for taking the actions they



do; nobody feels like a token character for the duration of the show.

Speaking of the duration, this is an anime that is 25 episodes long, and actually has a conclusion! Those 25 episodes will be a ride though, with funny moments, nail biting moments

and tearful ones. That's not a bad thing at all. Anything that can make you feel all those things in 25 episodes warrants a watch, for sure.

Now, coming to the plot – or at least the way synopsis describes it to avoid spoilers – we've got our two main characters in Ryuuji Takasu, a supposedly gentle soul cursed with a scary face which makes it look like he's trying to pick a fight with everyone, and Taiga Aisaka, a tiny harmless looking girl, who will beat you up with a baseball bat if you look at her funny. This conflict between their outward appearances and their personalities is the pillar upon which Toradora is built. It's a mighty fine foundation. Upon crossing paths (there's certainly fireworks when that happens, considering how different they are) they learn that they each have crushes on the others' best friend, and so they decide to help each other out. Also, Taiga is probably the gold standard for "tsundere" characters in anime; we needn't say any more.